PAZ · A ONE-WEEK TOOL

Peace by design

a calm week, on purpose.

Calm isn't a personality trait. It's a design. This is the method I use to run a home with three girls, a career and no family around the corner. Fill it in on Sunday night. Pencil is fine. So is coffee.

SUNDAY NIGHT · 10 MINUTES · ONE PAGE PER WEEK

0 First, assume chaos will come

The sick kid, the forgotten PE bag, the "quick call" at five to five. Chaos isn't proof that you failed. It's part of the week. So the plan makes room for it, instead of pretending it won't show up.

1 Destination: where do you want to land?

What does a calm week look like, this week? One sentence. Not a perfect week. A calm one.

Mine: *"We walk in at 8 pm on Tuesday and dinner is ready."*

This week, calm means:

2 Bridge: what has to be true for that?

Think in three kinds of things: tasks, conversations and mindsets.

Mine: *cook Tuesday's dinner on Monday night. Pack the sports bags the night before.*

A task:

A conversation:

A mindset:

3 Execution: every task gets a slot

"When I can" is not a time. A task without a slot lives in your head, and your head is already full. This week I have 19 extras on the fridge list. That's 19 slots.

TASK	DAY	SLOT
Cook Tuesday's dinner	*Mon*	*after bedtime*

4 Buffers: leave room on purpose

Block empty time in your week and protect it. That's where chaos lands without knocking everything else over. And if nothing happens? You just got time back.

My buffer blocks this week:

5 Prep tomorrow, today, and the 3 pm switch

Ten minutes tonight saves the worst half hour of tomorrow morning. And at 3 pm I close the laptop. Not because the work is done. Because pickup is. The routine cards on the wall carry the afternoon, so I don't have to say everything five times.

- ☐ Bags packed and waiting by the door
- ☐ Clothes picked out
- ☐ Tomorrow's dinner decided (or already made)
- ☐ Tomorrow's calendar checked, buffer included
- ☐ 3 pm: laptop closed. The workday ends at pickup
- ☐ Routine cards up where the afternoon happens (snack, homework, play)
- ☐ My own: _____

6 The 30-free-minutes rule

When 30 minutes open up, don't hand them to your phone. Move the next priority forward, even if it was planned for later.

My next 30-minute move: _____

7 Staying calm: the inner work

The system holds the week. You hold the peace. And that part doesn't go in a calendar. It's practised.

What works for me: I talk to myself a lot (yes, out loud). I check in with myself. Every so often I sit down for a longer "who am I?" session, because when you live abroad with kids, it's very easy to lose yourself. I keep a 5-year plan as a rough map of my life, and I do a yearly review. Personality, temperament, astrology, even a palm reading: I've tried them all. The good, the bad and the ugly.

Daily check-in

Two minutes. Any time.

How am I, really?

What do I need today?

What can wait?

Who-am-I session

When you feel yourself fading.

What matters to me, here and now?

What part of me did I leave behind when I moved? Do I want it back?

What do I keep, wherever I live?

Yearly review

Plus your 5-year map.

What gave me energy this year? What drained it?

Where do I want to be in 5 years, roughly?

One thing to start, one to stop, one to keep.

Calm isn't the absence of chaos. It's having somewhere for it to land.

with love, Stef

RAISING MORE THAN ONE CHILD? DM ME MAPA ON INSTAGRAM FOR THE FAMILY TEMPERAMENT MAP.
IS YOUR WORK NO LONGER FITTING YOUR HOME? DM ME FREEDOM FOR THE FREE FIT CHECK.